PRD-LITE · v2.0

BeReal Passport & Community Boards

October 27, 2026 · Lashawn Fofung, MBA, PMP, CSM, CSPO · Status: tested with 5 users; refine, then retest

PROBLEM

BeReal's daily users fell from about 15M to about 6M. Casual users often post once and lose any reason to reopen BeReal — the feed goes quiet after the post, and the one-photo format can start to feel repetitive with no sense of shared occasion.

TARGET USER

Casual and drifting BeReal users, centered on "Denise," an introverted first-time user who values privacy and feels stressed by forced, real-time posting. She needs a lightweight, opt-in reason to come back — without added pressure or competition.

MAU SUCCESS METRICS

North Star: DAU/MAU (stickiness). Primary: daily open rate (sessions per user per day; target 2.5x, to validate in the MVP)

Secondary: % of daily posts on a board; Passport / Squad Stamp Tally visits; D7 and D30 retention; taps and time from capture to stamped post

USER TESTING (OCTOBER 2026)

5-person focus group: 4 of 5 would open BeReal more often; reminders and streak scored 4.2/5 for low pressure; launch vote 3 yes · 1 maybe · 1 no. Main friction: too many taps from capture to stamp. Next: refine, then retest with 7–10 people.

ASSUMPTIONS & NON-GOALS

Assumptions:

- Users will enjoy an opt-in, lightweight community ritual without feeling pressured.
- A monthly set of themed boards and a daily prompt create enough curiosity to justify a return visit.
- Enough of a squad will opt in for a capsule to feel alive (critical mass).

Non-Goals:

- No sponsor / ad-serving logic in MVP (data model support only; sponsored boards are a later pilot).
- No public leaderboard outside the squad.
- No changes to the core once-daily notification or capture mechanic.

USER STORIES

- As a BeReal user, I want to see this month's boards and today's prompt when I open the app, so that I have a reason to check in and something fresh to think about.
- As a BeReal user, I want to choose, after taking my photo, whether to SEND it as usual or post it to a Community Board, so that I can join in with my squad — without being forced to.
- As a BeReal user, I want to browse a board and react to my squad's posts, so that I feel connected to what my squad is doing this month.
- As a BeReal user, I want to opt in or out of each board anytime, so that I stay in control of my experience.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Boards open automatically at 12:00 AM in the user's local timezone and are visible on the Today screen — a fixed reset, not a timed post.
- After capture, the user chooses SEND (regular post, no stamp) or COMMUNITY BOARD (themed post + stamp to one active board) — never auto opted-in.
- A board post appears in that board's feed and the monthly capsule with its passport stamp, visible only to opted-in squad members; reactions are squad-only, with no public like counts.
- User can view a personal BeReal Passport (stamps earned) and the Squad Stamp Tally — both ship in the MVP, not deferred.
- Settings → Opt-in / Opt-out - Community Board lets the user switch each board on or off anytime, without losing the ability to post regularly.
- The board post uses the same photo as a standard BeReal — no filters, retakes, or new content requirements.

GUARDRAILS (BEREAL BRAND FIT)

- Authenticity — the underlying photo never changes; tagging is a layer on top, not a new content requirement.

- Privacy — boards and capsules are visible only to opted-in squad members within the existing friend graph; no public leaderboard or like counts.
- Simplicity — adds one post-type choice after capture; cutting taps from capture to stamp is the top fix from testing.
- Positive Behavior — stamps and the Squad Stamp Tally reward participation without shame-based or loss-framed messaging.

Revision history: v1.0 (September 2026) initial draft · v2.0 (October 27, 2026) updated after the 5-person focus group: retitled; persona, post types, reactions, settings and metrics aligned to the tested prototype; test results added.